

Editions of the *Suśrutasaṃhitā*

Deepro Chakraborty

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1. **Tyler, John (1834) “Translation of two chapters of the First Part of the Soosroota”.**

The earliest known translation of any portion of the *Suśrutasaṃhitā* into a European language appears to be John Tytler’s “Translation of two chapters of the First Part of the Soosroota.” The work consists of a translation of chapters 4 and 5 of the *Sūtrasthāna*. Tytler enclosed the translation in a letter dated 29 January 1834 addressed to Captain Troyer, secretary of the Sanskrit College from 1833 to 1835. The translation is reproduced in ch.,4 Sen, S. N. (1991), “Medical and Technical Education,” in *Scientific and Technical Education in India 1781–1900* (New Delhi: Indian National Science Academy), 125–61. DOI: [10.5281/zenodo.17561581](https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.17561581): 160–161.

The translation was produced in the context of debates over medical education in colonial India. Following a proposal submitted by the Sanskrit College, Calcutta, to the General Committee of Public Instruction in June 1826, medical instruction was introduced at the College under Tytler’s supervision. Students were taught both traditional Āyurvedic works, including the compendia of Caraka and Suśruta, and European medical texts. In March 1834, Captain Troyer sought Tytler’s opinion on a proposal to abandon Sanskrit medical texts altogether and teach European medicine exclusively through English textbooks. By that time, Tytler had been serving as superintendent of the School for Native Doctors since 1830. As a committed orientalist and admirer of Sanskrit and Arabic scientific literature, he

strongly opposed the proposal. The letter containing his translation of SS 1.4–5 was written only two months before this exchange.¹

2. **Gupta, Madhusudana (1835–36) (ed.),** *The Suśruta, or system of medicine, taught by Dhanwantari, and composed by his disciple Suśruta*, 2 vols. (Calcutta: Education Press; Baptist Mission Press), [ark:/13960/t6841qw6x](https://nopr.scribd.org/ark:/13960/t6841qw6x); Vol. I: Sutra, Nidana and Sarira (Education Press, 1835). Vol. II: Chikitsa, Kalpa and Uttara Tantra (Baptist Mission Press, 1836).

The editio princeps of the *Suśrutasaṃhitā* was published by Madhusudan Gupta, professor of medicine at the Sanskrit College, Calcutta. Gupta had also assisted John Tytler at the School for Native Doctors for two years, helping explain English medical terminology to students in Sanskrit and Bengali. The edition was published in two volumes in Devanagari script in 1835 and 1836.

Gupta did not indicate the manuscripts or other sources used in preparing the text. The edition was reprinted in four volumes in Calcutta in 1868, and a second edition in two volumes appeared in 1874.²

3. **Bhaṭṭācāryya, Jīvānanda Vidyāsāgara (1873) (ed.),** *Suśrutah | Sūtranidānaśarīracikitsākalpottaratāntrakalpitaḥ* (1st Edition, Calcutta: Dvaipāyana Press); 2nd ed., Calcutta 1886; 3rd ed., Calcutta 1889 ([ark:/13960/t80k7t407](https://nopr.scribd.org/ark:/13960/t80k7t407)); 4th ed., Calcutta 1899.

Jīvānanda Vidyāsāgara Bhaṭṭācāryya published an edition of the *Suśrutasaṃhitā* in Devanagari script at Calcutta in 1873. In many of his editions, Bhaṭṭācāryya reproduced texts from earlier printed editions without acknowledging his sources. His edition of the SS is also likely taken from Gupta's editio princeps. Subsequent editions were published in 1886, 1889, and 1899.

4. **Bandopadhyāya, Ombica Charana (1873–74) (ed. and trans.),** *সু-শ্রুত । প্রাচীন হিন্দুদিগের চিকিৎসা বিজ্ঞান । বাঙ্গলা অনুবাদ এবং সংস্করণ Medical science of the ancient Hindoos translated and edited* (1st edition, Kalikātā: Bhikṭoriyā Yantrālaya), [ark:/13960/t4km6hz1w](https://nopr.scribd.org/ark:/13960/t4km6hz1w); 2nd ed., Calcutta 1885 ([ark:/13960/s2ckqqbfsk2](https://nopr.scribd.org/ark:/13960/s2ckqqbfsk2)).

¹See Sen 1991: 145, 151–152, 160–161.

²HIML: 1B, 311.

In Śaka 1795 (1873/74 CE), Ambikā Carāṇa Bandyopādhyāya published an edition of the *Suśrutasamhitā* in Bengali script together with a Bengali translation in two volumes. A second edition appeared in 1885. As in the case of Bhaṭṭācāryya's edition, no information is given regarding the sources used in establishing the text. It is likewise quite plausible that the edition ultimately derives from Gupta's editio princeps.